

1. What is an Operating System & Types of OS

An operating system (OS) is software that acts as an interface between computer hardware and user applications. It manages the resources and provides services for the efficient and secure execution of programs. The primary functions of an operating system include process management, memory management, file system management, device management, and user interface.

1. **Windows:** Developed by Microsoft, Windows is a widely used operating system for personal computers. It offers a user-friendly interface, supports a vast range of software applications, and is compatible with various hardware configurations.
2. **macOS:** Developed by Apple, macOS is the operating system used on Apple Mac computers. It provides a sleek and intuitive user interface, seamless integration with other Apple devices, and a robust ecosystem of software applications.
3. **Linux:** Linux is an open-source operating system that is highly customizable and widely used in server environments and embedded systems. It offers high level of stability, security, and flexibility. There are many different versions (called *distributions* or *distros*) of the Linux operating system,
 1. Ubuntu - easy to use , good for beginners
 2. fedora -more up to data for advance user or developers
 3. CentOS - stable or reliable

4. **Android:** Developed by Google, Android is an open-source operating system primarily designed for mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets. It offers a rich ecosystem of applications and customization options.
5. **iOS:** Developed by Apple, iOS is the operating system used on iPhones, iPads, and iPods. It provides a seamless and secure user experience, focusing on performance and integration with other Apple devices.
6. **Real-Time Operating Systems (RTOS):** RTOS is designed for systems that require deterministic and real-time response. It is commonly used in embedded systems, control systems, and IoT devices.

What is Multiprogramming?

Multiprogramming is a technique where the **operating system keeps loading multiple programs into memory at the same time**, so the CPU is always busy doing useful work.

In the early days of computing, computers could only run **one program at a time**. Once that program was done — or while it was waiting for something like a disk read or user input — the CPU would just sit there doing **nothing**. This was a massive waste of an expensive resource.

Multiprogramming was the solution to this problem.

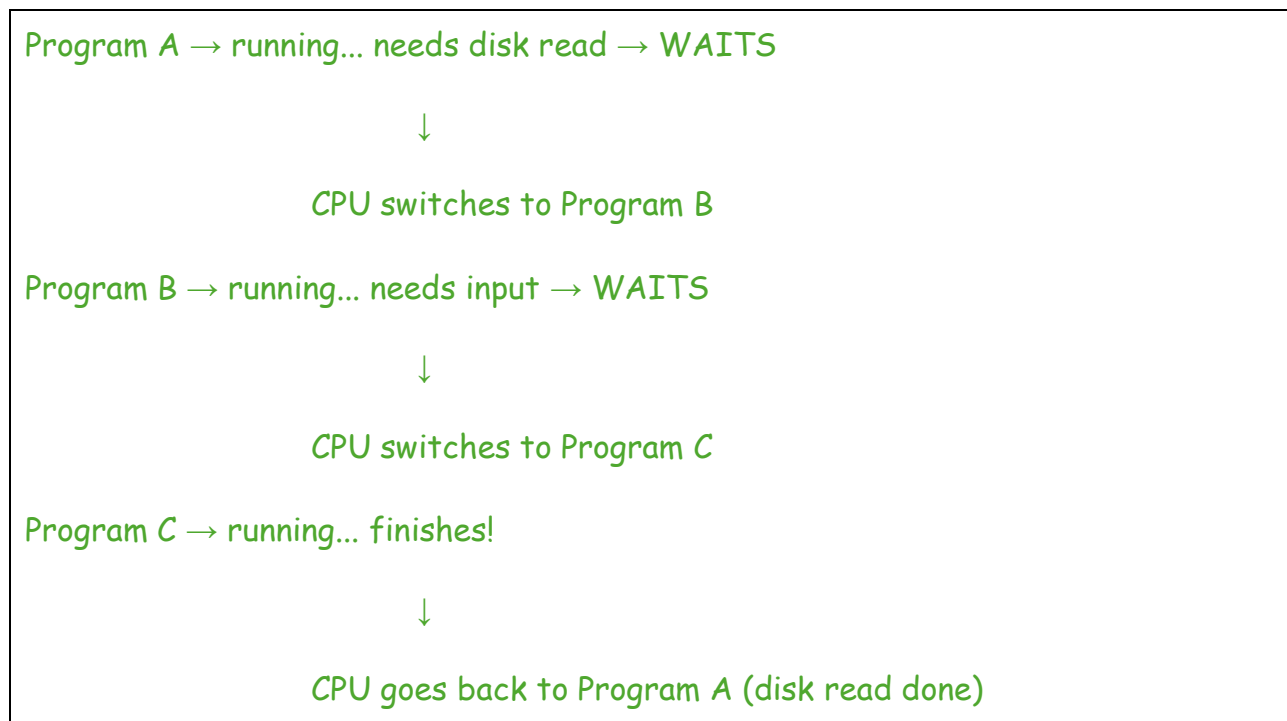
The Core Idea

The fundamental insight behind multiprogramming is simple: **a CPU is incredibly fast, but the things it has to wait for (disk, keyboard, network) are incredibly slow** — sometimes thousands of times slower.

So instead of waiting, the OS says:

"While Program A is waiting for its file to load, let me run Program B instead."

This way, the CPU stays productive at all times, switching between programs whenever one of them hits a waiting point.



How the OS Manages It

- **Loads multiple programs into RAM** — each program gets its own section of memory.

- **Tracks the state of each program** — is it running, waiting, or ready?
- **Switches the CPU** from one program to another when the current one is blocked (waiting for I/O).
- **Resumes programs** exactly where they left off once their wait is over.